

The Complete Pathway: ECFMG Certification to Match Day

A step-by-step reference for International Medical Graduates preparing for the 2027 National Resident Matching Program Match

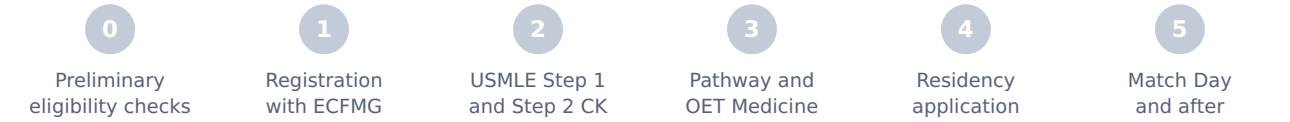
Edition: First edition, August 2026
Last verified: 18 August 2026 against ecfmg.org, usmle.org, nrmp.org and aamc.org
Scheduled re-verification: 1 November 2026
Intended reader: Any international medical student or graduate beginning the pathway with no institutional advising

Document Summary

This guide sets out the complete route from initial eligibility to the start of residency training in the United States, written for readers who are beginning with no prior knowledge of the system and no faculty advisor to consult. It is organised into six sequential stages. A progress diagram appears at the end of each stage so that the reader can locate their own position on the pathway at any point. A glossary of all technical terms appears at the end of the document.

- The pathway comprises six stages: **preliminary eligibility checks**, **registration with ECFMG**, **the USMLE examinations**, **completion of certification requirements**, **the residency application**, and **the Match and its aftermath**.
- A change of major practical significance took effect on **12 January 2026**: all USMLE examination services for international medical graduates transferred from ECFMG to the Federation of State Medical Boards. Examination registration is no longer performed through MyIntealth. Guidance published before this date is unreliable on this point.
- All examination requirements for ECFMG Certification must be satisfied within a **seven-year period** measured from the earliest passing examination. ECFMG does not issue reminders and does not notify applicants when a passing performance expires.
- For the 2027 Match, applications may be submitted from **2 September 2026**, programmes begin review on **23 September 2026**, rank order lists must be certified by **3 March 2027**, and Match Day falls on **19 March 2027**.
- In the 2026 Match, **56.4 per cent** of non-United States citizen international medical graduates matched to a first-year position. The figure was 54.4 per cent among those requiring visa sponsorship and 67.9 per cent among United States permanent residents.
- The three factors that most commonly delay or defeat applicants are late credential verification, examinations attempted before the candidate is ready, and application lists that are too short or poorly targeted. All three are within the applicant's control.

PATHWAY OVERVIEW — THE SIX STAGES OF THIS GUIDE



How to use this document

Read the whole guide once before acting on any part of it, because several later requirements have deadlines that must be anticipated years in advance. Thereafter, use the progress diagrams to return to the stage that concerns you. Every organisation named in this guide publishes its own authoritative instructions, and those instructions take precedence over this summary in every case. A list of official sources appears before the glossary.

A NOTE ON FEES

Specific fee amounts are deliberately omitted from this edition. Fees are set independently by ECFMG, the Federation of State Medical Boards, the Association of American Medical Colleges, the National Resident Matching Program and the Occupational English Test, and each is revised periodically. Consult the fee page of each organisation directly and budget for the total before beginning.

STAGE ZERO

Preliminary Eligibility Checks

Three matters should be settled before any fee is paid or any examination is scheduled. Each can be resolved at no cost, and each has ended pathways that were otherwise well prepared.

1. Confirmation that the medical school qualifies

Eligibility begins with the medical school rather than with the applicant. The school must appear in the **World Directory of Medical Schools** and its entry must carry an **ECFMG Sponsor Note** stating that it meets ECFMG eligibility requirements. The applicant's graduation year must fall within the range of graduation years specified in that note. Where a school is absent from the directory, or where the note does not cover the relevant year, the applicant should contact ECFMG directly before incurring any expense.

2. The credit-year requirement

An applicant must have been awarded credit for at least **four credit years** — academic years for which credit has been granted toward completion of the medical curriculum — by a school meeting the requirements above. Restrictions apply to credits transferred from another institution. Applicants who transferred between medical schools should review the ECFMG policy on transfer credits carefully, as this is a recognised source of late disqualification.

3. An honest assessment of time and resources

The pathway involves examination fees, credential verification fees, an English language examination, application fees that scale with the number of programmes applied to, and in most cases international travel. From a standing start it commonly occupies between eighteen months and three years. Applicants who plan the expenditure at the outset fare considerably better than those who discover it midway.

PROGRESS — YOU ARE AT STAGE 0



STAGE ONE

Registration with ECFMG

The Educational Commission for Foreign Medical Graduates, a division of Intealth, certifies international medical graduates for entry into accredited United States graduate medical education. Registration is undertaken by the applicant personally. Medical schools do not perform it on a student's behalf.

Establishing a MyIntealth account

The applicant creates an account on the MyIntealth platform. The name recorded must correspond **exactly** to the name on the applicant's current, unexpired passport. This requirement is not administrative pedantry: examination registration is subsequently handled by a separate organisation which requires an exact match against the Intealth record, and discrepancies discovered late are troublesome to correct.

Identity verification

ECFMG verifies the applicant's identity through the process specified within the platform. This is completed before an application for certification can be accepted.

The Application for ECFMG Certification

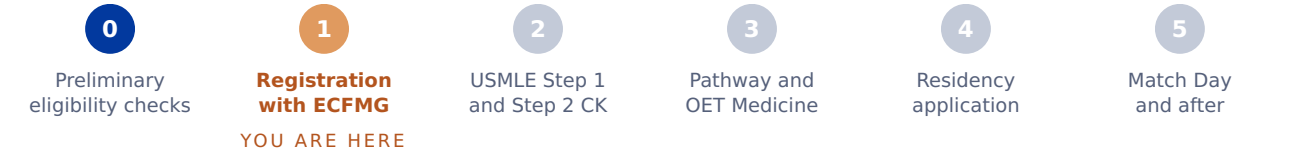
This application confirms the applicant's intention to pursue certification and records their medical education in detail. Its treatment differs according to the applicant's status.

- **Students currently enrolled** may have the application accepted on the basis of enrolment, and may then apply for examinations as students.
- **Graduates** must submit their final medical diploma, final medical transcript and any transcripts documenting transfer credits. These credentials must be submitted to primary-source verification — that is, confirmed by ECFMG directly with the issuing school — and accepted before the application for certification is accepted.

Primary-source verification proceeds at the pace of the issuing institution and is, for most applicants, the first serious delay encountered. It should be initiated at the earliest opportunity rather than when an examination date is contemplated.

> CRITICAL: THE TRANSITION FROM STUDENT TO GRADUATE
>
> Where an application for certification was accepted while the applicant was a student, and the applicant has since graduated or the recorded attendance end date has passed, the application must be updated and the medical education credentials submitted for verification. Until that is done, ECFMG will not confirm the applicant as eligible, and any subsequent examination registration will be blocked. The reason for the block is not always evident to the applicant. The status of the application should be confirmed as *Accepted* within MyIntealth before every examination application.

PROGRESS — YOU ARE AT STAGE 1



STAGE TWO

The USMLE Examinations

CHANGE EFFECTIVE 12 JANUARY 2026

All USMLE Step examination services for international medical graduates — registration, payment, score report delivery, eligibility period extensions, testing region changes and customer service — are now provided by the **Federation of State Medical Boards** through its portal at usmle.fsmb.org. These services are no longer available within MyIntealth. Instructional material published before January 2026, including video guidance that remains widely circulated, describes a registration route that no longer exists.

The relationship between the two organisations

Responsibility is now divided. ECFMG determines **eligibility**; the Federation of State Medical Boards administers **examinations**. When an applicant applies for any Step examination, the Federation confirms with ECFMG that the applicant is eligible for ECFMG Certification. The Application for ECFMG Certification must therefore be accepted before a first examination application can be made, and must remain in good standing for each subsequent one.

The examinations required for certification

USMLE Step 1 assesses foundational medical science and has been reported on a pass or fail basis since January 2022. It must be passed. Unsuccessful attempts remain visible to residency programmes, and the examination should therefore be attempted only when preparation is genuinely complete.

USMLE Step 2 Clinical Knowledge assesses clinical knowledge and is reported as a numerical score. Because Step 1 no longer produces a score, the Step 2 CK result is the principal standardised measure by which residency programmes compare applicants from every medical school in the world. For international applicants, whose institutional grades cannot readily be interpreted by United States programmes, its weight is greater still. It warrants the most substantial preparation of any single element of the pathway.

The order in which the two examinations are taken is at the applicant's discretion. **USMLE Step 3** is not required for certification; it requires a valid, unexpired ECFMG Certificate at the time of application and on each test day, and is ordinarily taken during residency, though some applicants take it earlier for reasons discussed at Stage Five.

Practical matters

- The name held by the Federation of State Medical Boards must match the Intealth record exactly. Discrepancies should be resolved before applying.
- Each examination application carries an eligibility period within which the examination must be taken. Extensions and changes of testing region are now requested from the Federation.
- Score release timing should be worked backwards from the application season. An applicant intending to apply in September should ordinarily sit Step 2 CK sufficiently early for the score to be reported before programmes begin their review.

THE SEVEN-YEAR RULE

ECFMG requires that all examination requirements for certification be satisfied within a **seven-year period**. The period runs from the applicant's earliest passing performance. If the remaining requirements — including completion of a Pathway — are not met within that period, the earliest passing performance ceases to be valid for certification, and the seven-year period is then measured afresh from the next earliest passing performance. In practice this can require an applicant to retake an examination already passed. **ECFMG does not notify applicants of an approaching deadline and does not notify them when a passing performance has expired.** Responsibility for monitoring the period rests entirely with the applicant, who may track progress on the ECFMG Certificate tab within MyIntealth.

PROGRESS — YOU ARE AT STAGE 2



STAGE THREE

Completing Certification: Pathways and OET Medicine

Passing Step 1 and Step 2 CK satisfies the **medical science examination requirement**. Certification additionally requires satisfaction of the **clinical skills requirement** and the **communication skills requirement**. Following the discontinuation of the former Step 2 Clinical Skills examination, these are met by completing an ECFMG Pathway together with a satisfactory score on the Occupational English Test in its medicine version.

OET Medicine

The Occupational English Test is an English language examination designed for healthcare professionals, with a version specific to physicians. A satisfactory score is required of **every applicant**, including native English speakers and graduates of medical schools where instruction was conducted in English. Test seats are finite and demand rises sharply as application season approaches; early booking is prudent.

The Pathways

Applications are submitted through MyIntealth. Each Match season has its own application window and its own supporting-document deadlines, and applications are not determined until every required document and verification has been received.

- **Pathway 1** is for applicants who currently hold, or have recently held, a licence or registration to practise medicine without supervision in another country. Documentation, ordinarily a certificate or letter of good standing, must be sent to ECFMG directly by the issuing licensing authority and must have been issued within the prescribed recency window.
- **Pathways 2 to 5** accommodate applicants without such a licence, and are founded variously on the characteristics of the applicant's medical school and on assessment of clinical skills. Pathway 2 involves an attestation concerning the school's objective structured clinical examination, which carries its own fixed deadline within each season.
- **Pathway 6** must be used by any applicant who failed the former Step 2 Clinical Skills examination on one or more occasions, irrespective of eligibility for any other Pathway.

> TIMING AGAINST THE 2027 MATCH
>
> For an applicant to participate in the 2027 Match, ECFMG must determine the outcome of the Pathways application, establish overall Match eligibility including verification of passing performance on Step 1 and Step 2 CK, and report that eligibility to the National Resident Matching Program by the rank order list certification deadline of **3 March 2027**. Because processing does not commence until all supporting documentation is in hand, applications made late in the season carry material risk.

A certificate issued on the basis of a Pathway becomes valid indefinitely only once the holder has completed at least twelve months of clinical education in an accredited United States graduate medical education programme, or in a recognised non-standard training programme associated with one, or holds an unrestricted licence to practise in a United States jurisdiction.

PROGRESS — YOU ARE AT STAGE 3



STAGE FOUR

The Residency Application

Two separate registrations are required, and a third system applies to certain specialties. Applicants who confuse them lose the season.

The Electronic Residency Application Service

ERAS, operated by the Association of American Medical Colleges, carries the application itself. International applicants obtain an **ERAS token** through MyIntealth — this service remained with ECFMG after the examination transition — and then compose the application within the MyERAS portal. For the 2027 season the section formerly titled Publications is designated **Scholarly Work**, and all letters of recommendation are transmitted through the **AAMC Letter Writer Portal**.

The National Resident Matching Program

Registration with the NRMP is entirely separate and is not effected by submitting an ERAS application. An applicant who neglects it may complete a full season of interviews and yet be absent from the matching algorithm.

ResidencyCAS

Emergency Medicine and Obstetrics and Gynecology no longer use ERAS. Both specialties have moved to ResidencyCAS, a separate application system with its own requirements and fees. Applicants to either must operate two systems concurrently.

Programme signals

A programme signal is a limited token attached to an application to indicate genuine interest in a particular programme. Programmes treat signals as one of several considerations when deciding whom to interview. The number available differs by specialty, being set by each specialty in light of its size and application volume, and participation is optional at programme level. AAMC guidance is that applicants should use all signals available to them, and should direct them to the programmes in which they are most interested. AAMC has reported that sending a signal was associated with a higher probability of receiving an interview invitation in every participating specialty.

Key dates for the 2027 Match

Date	Event
2 September 2026, 9:00 a.m. ET	Applicants may begin submitting MyERAS applications to programmes
15 September 2026	NRMP registration opens
23 September 2026	Programmes begin reviewing applications
29 January 2027	NRMP standard registration deadline; late fee applies thereafter
1 February 2027	Rank order list entry opens
3 March 2027	Rank order list certification deadline; ECFMG deadline to report eligibility to NRMP
15–19 March 2027	Match Week, including the Supplemental Offer and Acceptance Program
19 March 2027	Match Day

Sources: AAMC 2027 ERAS timeline; NRMP 2027 Main Residency Match applicant calendar.

> THE DISTINCTION THAT MATTERS MOST IN SEPTEMBER
>
> Submission on 2 September confers no advantage over submission a fortnight later, because no programme reviews any application before 23 September. What matters is that the application is **complete** by that date. Applicants routinely submit early and are then held up by an outstanding verification or an unreceived letter, and are consequently reviewed late or not at all.

Constructing the programme list

Of the decisions remaining to an applicant in September, the composition of the programme list is the most consequential.

- **Apply broadly.** The number of interviews obtained is the strongest practical determinant of matching that remains within the applicant's influence. Applying to too few programmes is the most common recoverable error and is rarely recoverable within the same season.
- **Filter on stated requirements.** Visa sponsorship, limits on years since graduation, minimum Step 2 CK scores and expectations of United States clinical experience vary widely. These should be confirmed programme by programme through the FREIDA directory and programme websites.
- **Examine the record.** A programme's published roster of current residents indicates whether it has previously trained international graduates and from which countries. A programme accustomed to international applications is better equipped to interpret one.
- **Weigh United States clinical experience.** Hands-on experience in the United States, and the letters of recommendation it generates, is among the most frequently reported differentiators between matched and unmatched international applicants.
- **Treat specialty selection as strategy.** Internal Medicine offered 11,632 categorical and primary positions in the 2026 Match and filled 95.2 per cent of them, and is by volume the principal destination for international graduates. Family Medicine left 899 positions unfilled. Pediatrics filled 94.4 per cent of 3,185 positions. Surgical and highly competitive specialties admit far fewer international graduates, and within general surgery international applicants are disproportionately represented in preliminary rather than categorical positions.

Source: NRMP 2026 Main Residency Match Results and Data.

Interviews

Interviews are conducted between October and January and, for international applicants, are almost invariably virtual. They should be prepared for with the seriousness accorded an examination: the applicant's own narrative, the content of their application, their reasons for the specialty, and informed questions about the particular programme.

PROGRESS — YOU ARE AT STAGE 4



STAGE FIVE

The Match, Match Week and What Follows

The rank order list

Following interviews, applicants submit a rank order list recording the programmes at which they would accept a position, in order of preference. Programmes submit corresponding lists of applicants. The matching algorithm is constructed so that an applicant's interests are best served by ranking programmes in their **true order of preference**. Strategic misrepresentation of preference does not improve outcomes. The list must be certified by 3 March 2027.

Match Week

Match Week for the 2027 Match runs from 15 to 19 March 2027, with Match Day on 19 March. Applicants who do not match are eligible to participate in the **Supplemental Offer and Acceptance Program**, through which unfilled positions are offered during that week. The process is compressed and demanding, and a substantial number of positions are filled through it each year. Applicants who neither match nor obtain a position through SOAP frequently succeed in a subsequent cycle, most often after addressing a specific identified weakness. An unsuccessful cycle is a delay rather than a verdict.

Immigration status

Applicants who are neither United States citizens nor lawful permanent residents require appropriate immigration status to train. The majority of international residents train under **J-1 sponsorship arranged through ECFMG's Exchange Visitor Sponsorship Program**, a service that remained with ECFMG. A minority of programmes sponsor the H-1B classification instead; this route is commonly associated with a requirement that Step 3 has already been passed, which is one reason some applicants sit Step 3 earlier than is otherwise necessary. The graduate medical education office of the matched programme administers the process. This guide describes these arrangements in general terms only; applicants should rely on official government sources and, where appropriate, qualified legal advice.

Onboarding

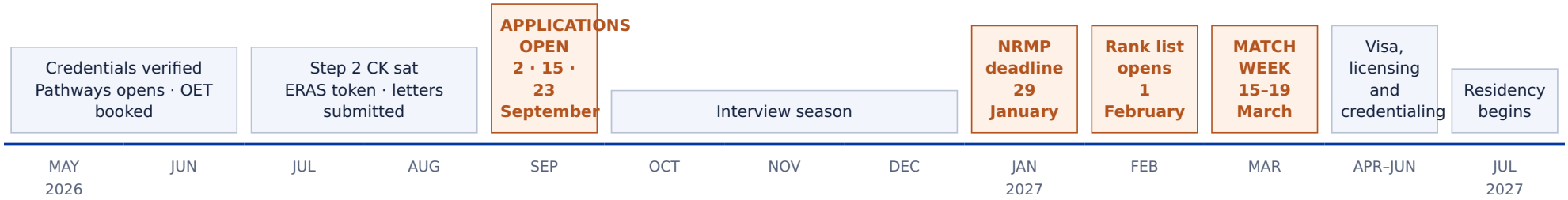
Certification must be complete before accredited training may begin, so any outstanding requirement becomes urgent at this point. State licensing documentation, hospital credentialing and occupational health clearance follow. Residency ordinarily commences on or about 1 July.

PROGRESS — THE PATHWAY COMPLETE



The 2027 Application Year at a Glance

The strip below sets out the application year for a candidate applying in September 2026 for training commencing in July 2027. Items marked in orange are fixed external deadlines set by other organisations; the remainder are recommended working targets that the applicant sets for themselves. Precise dates appear in the table of key dates at Stage Four.



THE SAME YEAR EXPRESSED AS THE SIX STAGES OF THIS GUIDE



Indicative durations from a standing start

Period	Activity
Months 0–3	Directory and credit-year checks; MyIntealth account; identity verification; Application for ECFMG Certification submitted; credential verification initiated
Months 3–15	Step 1 preparation and examination; planning of United States clinical experience
Months 12–24	Step 2 CK preparation and examination; clinical experience and letters of recommendation obtained; OET Medicine booked
Application year, January to August	Pathways application within the season window; OET completed; ERAS token obtained; personal statement drafted; letters submitted; programme list constructed
September	ERAS application submitted and completed before 23 September; NRMP registration
October to January	Interviews
February to March	Rank order list submitted and certified; Match Week
March to June	Immigration status, licensing and credentialing
1 July	Residency commences

Faster progress is achievable; slower progress is common. Time is most frequently lost to credential verification begun late and to examinations attempted prematurely.

An Honest Account of the Odds

Measure, 2026 Main Residency Match	Figure
Non-United States citizen international graduates, active applicants	11,944
Non-United States citizen international graduates matched to PGY-1	56.4 per cent
of whom, requiring visa sponsorship	54.4 per cent
of whom, United States permanent residents	67.9 per cent
United States citizen international graduates matched to PGY-1 (2025)	67.8 per cent
Internal Medicine positions offered / proportion filled	11,632 / 95.2 per cent
Pediatrics positions offered / proportion filled	3,185 / 94.4 per cent
Family Medicine positions unfilled	899

Sources: NRMP 2026 Main Residency Match Results and Data and accompanying press materials; NRMP 2025 Match results. The visa-status division was published by NRMP for the first time in 2026.

The 2026 figure of 56.4 per cent represents a five-year low, attributable principally to growth in applicant numbers outpacing growth in positions. It should be read carefully. It describes the composition of a pool, not the prospects of any particular person within it. A candidate with a strong Step 2 CK score, no unsuccessful attempts, genuine United States clinical experience and a broad, well-targeted programme list stands materially above that average; a candidate lacking those things stands below it. The variables that separate the two groups are, for the most part, decisions rather than circumstances.

Three further observations are offered without embellishment. **First**, no organisation in this system is monitoring an individual applicant's progress. ECFMG does not warn of the seven-year deadline. Programmes do not advise applicants that their files are incomplete. Those who succeed are, above all, those who administer their own affairs with discipline. **Second**, guarantees offered in exchange for payment should be treated with scepticism; every requirement described in this guide can be completed directly with the responsible organisation at the published fee, and the quality of commercially arranged clinical experience varies considerably. **Third**, information circulating in applicant communities is emotionally sustaining and factually unreliable; the widely repeated belief that registration confers a five-year window is a case in point, the actual rule being the seven-year provision described at Stage Two, which operates differently from the way it is commonly described.

Official Sources

Organisation or resource	Address
World Directory of Medical Schools	wdoms.org
ECFMG certification requirements and Information Booklet	ecfmg.org/certification
MyIntealth applicant portal	myintealth.app
USMLE Service Transition information hub	usmle.org/usmle-service-transition
Federation of State Medical Boards, USMLE portal	usmle.fsmb.org
ECFMG Pathways for the current season	ecfmg.org/certification-pathways
Occupational English Test	occupationalenglishtest.org
Electronic Residency Application Service	students-residents.aamc.org/eras
ResidencyCAS (Emergency Medicine, Obstetrics and Gynecology)	residencycas.org
National Resident Matching Program	nrmp.org
FREIDA residency programme directory	freida.ama-assn.org
ECFMG Exchange Visitor Sponsorship Program	ecfmg.org/evsp

Glossary of Terms

ACGME — Accreditation Council for Graduate Medical Education

The body that accredits residency and fellowship programmes in the United States. It requires that international graduates entering accredited programmes hold ECFMG Certification.

Categorical position

A residency position that proceeds through to completion of training in that specialty. To be distinguished from a preliminary position.

Credential verification (primary-source verification)

The process by which ECFMG confirms an applicant's medical education documents directly with the issuing medical school rather than accepting copies from the applicant.

Credit year

An academic year for which credit has been awarded toward completion of a medical curriculum. At least four are required for ECFMG eligibility, subject to restrictions on transferred credit.

ECFMG — Educational Commission for Foreign Medical Graduates

A division of Intealth. The organisation that certifies international medical graduates as ready to enter United States graduate medical education, and that determines their eligibility to sit the USMLE.

ECFMG Certificate

The document confirming that an international graduate has satisfied the examination, clinical skills and communication skills requirements and that their credentials have been verified. Required before accredited training may begin, and required to sit Step 3.

ERAS — Electronic Residency Application Service

The application system operated by the AAMC through which applicants transmit their applications to residency programmes. Distinct from the Match itself.

ERAS token

The access credential permitting an international applicant to open a MyERAS application. Obtained by international graduates through MyIntealth.

FSMB — Federation of State Medical Boards

Since 12 January 2026, the provider of all USMLE examination services to international medical graduates, including registration, score reporting and customer service.

Intealth

The parent organisation of which ECFMG is a division, and the operator of the MyIntealth platform.

IMG — International Medical Graduate

A physician who obtained their medical degree from a school outside the United States and Canada. The term describes the school, not the physician's citizenship: United States citizens who study abroad are also international medical graduates.

Letter Writer Portal

The AAMC system through which letters of recommendation are submitted for the ERAS application.

The Match

The annual process, operated by the NRMP, by which applicants and programmes submit ranked preferences and an algorithm assigns applicants to positions. Participation is binding.

MSPE — Medical Student Performance Evaluation

A summative evaluation of a student's performance prepared by their medical school and submitted with the residency application.

MyERAS

The applicant-facing portal within ERAS in which the application is composed and submitted.

MyIntealth

The ECFMG applicant platform, used for the Application for ECFMG Certification, credential verification, Pathways applications, ERAS token requests and J-1 sponsorship. Since January 2026 it is no longer used for USMLE registration.

NRMP — National Resident Matching Program

The organisation that operates the Main Residency Match. Registration with the NRMP is separate from, and additional to, the ERAS application.

OET Medicine — Occupational English Test

An English language examination for healthcare professionals, in a version specific to physicians. A satisfactory score is required of all applicants for ECFMG Certification, including native speakers.

Pathways

The set of six routes by which an applicant satisfies the clinical skills and communication skills requirements for certification, following the discontinuation of the Step 2 Clinical Skills examination.

PGY-1

Postgraduate year one, the first year of residency training, sometimes termed the intern year.

Preliminary position

A residency position lasting a single year and not continuing to completion of training. Holders must secure a further position to continue. International applicants are disproportionately represented in preliminary positions in some specialties.

Programme signal

A limited token attached to an application to indicate particular interest in a programme. Numbers available vary by specialty; participation by individual programmes is optional.

ResidencyCAS

The application system now used in place of ERAS by Emergency Medicine and Obstetrics and Gynecology.

ROL — Rank order list

The list of programmes an applicant submits to the NRMP, in true order of preference, before the certification deadline.

SOAP — Supplemental Offer and Acceptance Program

The process conducted during Match Week by which eligible unmatched applicants may be offered positions that remain unfilled.

Sponsor Note

The annotation in a medical school's World Directory entry confirming that the school meets ECFMG eligibility requirements, including the graduation years to which it applies.

USCE — United States Clinical Experience

Clinical experience obtained within the United States health system, ranging from observership without patient contact to hands-on sub-internship. Valued principally for the letters of recommendation and system familiarity it produces.

USMLE — United States Medical Licensing Examination

The three-step examination sequence for medical licensure in the United States. Step 1 and Step 2 Clinical Knowledge are required for ECFMG Certification; Step 3 requires a valid certificate and is ordinarily taken later.

Visa sponsorship (J-1 and H-1B)

The immigration arrangements under which international residents train. J-1 sponsorship for physicians is arranged through ECFMG's Exchange Visitor Sponsorship Program; a minority of programmes sponsor H-1B classification instead. Programmes differ in what, if anything, they sponsor.

Year of graduation restriction

A limit applied by some programmes on the number of years that may have elapsed since an applicant's graduation. Not published uniformly; must be confirmed programme by programme.

> VERIFICATION STATEMENT
>
> The contents of this guide were verified on 18 August 2026 against the ECFMG 2026 Information Booklet, the ECFMG MyIntealth frequently asked questions, the ECFMG 2027 Pathways pages, the USMLE Service Transition information hub, the AAMC 2027 ERAS materials and programme signalling guidance, and the National Resident Matching Program 2027 applicant calendar and 2026 Results and Data. Requirements, fees and dates are subject to revision by the responsible organisations. This edition is scheduled for re-verification on 1 November 2026. Readers who identify an error are invited to report it so that it may be corrected and the correction recorded.